

PODALYRIA

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PAPILIONACEAE/LEGUMINOSAE

Genus of evergreen, mainly summer-flowering shrubs, grown for their flowers and overall appearance. Frost tender. Requires full light and fertile, well-drained soil. Water containerized plants moderately, less when not in full growth. Prune, if necessary, after flowering. Propagate by seed in spring or by semiripe cuttings in summer.

P. sericea. Vigorous, rounded shrub. H 18–36in (45–90cm), S 1½–3ft (45–100cm). Has ovate, downy, mid-green leaves and sweet pealike, fragrant, pink flowers in summer. Z10–12 (min. 45°F/7°C)

PODOCARPUS

PODOCARPACEAE

See also CONIFERS.

P. andinus. See *Prumnopitys andina*.

P. macrophyllus (usamaki). Erect conifer. H 50ft (15m), S 20–25ft (6–8m). Long, linear leaves are bright green above, glaucous beneath. May be grown as a shrub, H and S 3–6ft (1–2m), and planted in a tub in hot climates. Z7–^a

P. nivalis (Alpine totara; illus. p.105). Rounded, spreading, shrubby conifer. H and S to 6ft (2m). Has reddish-brown, peeling bark and lance-shaped, sharp-pointed, rigid, dark green leaves. Bears catkinlike, yellow, male flowers and green, conelike, female flowers. Egg-shaped, red fruits follow in fall on female plants. Z7–11 **P. salignus** illus. p.100.

PODOPHYLLUM

SYN. DYSOSMA

BERBERIDACEAE

Genus of spring-flowering, rhizomatous perennials. Fully to frost hardy; young leaves may be damaged by frost. Prefers partial shade and moist, peaty soil. Propagate by division in spring or by seed in fall. ☉ All parts of the plants are highly toxic if ingested.

P. emodi. See *Sinopodophyllum hexandrum*.

P. hexandrum. See *Sinopodophyllum hexandrum*.

P. peltatum (American mandrake, May apple). Vigorous, spreading, rhizomatous perennial. H 1½ft (45cm), S 4ft (1.2m). Sometimes brown-mottled, light green leaves, with 3–5 deep lobes, push up through soil, looking like closed umbrellas. Nodding, cup-shaped, white flowers open under the foliage, from mid-spring to early summer. Produces large, fleshy, plumlike, glossy, deep rose-pink fruits in fall. Z3–8

PODRANEA

BIGNONIACEAE

Genus of one species of evergreen, twining climber, grown for its trumpet-shaped, foxglove-like flowers. Frost tender. Grow in full light and any fertile, well-drained soil. Water regularly, less in cold weather. Provide support. Thin out crowded growth in winter or early spring. Propagate by seed in spring or semiripe cuttings in summer.

P. ricasoliana, syn. *Pandorea ricasoliana*, *Tecoma ricasoliana*. Vigorous climber. H 12ft (4m) or more. Leaves have 5–11 lance-shaped to ovate, wavy, deep green leaflets. Loose clusters of fragrant, pink flowers, with darker veins, are borne from spring to fall. Z10–12 (min. 50°F/10°C)

Poinciana gilliesii. See *Caesalpinia gilliesii*.

Poinciana pulcherrima. See *Caesalpinia pulcherrima*.

POLEMONIUM

Jacob’s ladder

POLEMONIACEAE

Genus of late spring- or summer-flowering annuals and often short-lived perennials. Fully hardy. Prefers sun and fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate by division in spring or by seed in fall.

P. archibaldiae. Robust, bushy, clump-forming perennial. H to 3ft (1m), S 1ft (30cm). Leaves have 21 to 31 lance-shaped leaflets. Erect stems bear clusters of bell-shaped, usually deep violet-blue flowers in late spring, summer, and occasionally early fall. White-flowered forms are usually scented. Z6–10

P. boreale, syn. *P. pulcherrimum*. Vigorous, summer-flowering perennial. H 20in (50cm), S 1ft (30cm). Has bright green leaves divided into leaflets and tubular, purple-blue flowers with throats of yellow or white. Z3–8

P. caeruleum illus. p.270. **BRISE D’ANJOU** (‘Blanjou’) illus. p.270.

P. carneum illus. p.269.

P. foliosissimum. Vigorous, clump-forming perennial. H 30in (75cm), S 2ft (60cm). Clusters of cup-shaped, lilac flowers, with yellow stamens, are borne in summer at the stem tips, above oblong to lance-shaped, mid-green leaves, each composed of numerous, small leaflets. Z3–8. **var. flavum**, H 16–28in (40–70cm), bears yellow flowers shaded orange-red outside.

P. ‘Northern Lights’. Compact, upright perennial. H 12–16in (30–40cm), S 1ft (30cm). Has finely divided, bright green leaves. From late spring to early fall, produces clusters of fragrant, cup-shaped, pale blue flowers. Z3–8

P. pulcherrimum. See *P. boreale*.

POLIANTHES

ASPARAGACEAE

Genus of tuberous perennials, grown for their fragrant flowers in summer. Half hardy to frost tender. Needs a sheltered site in full sun and well-drained soil. Water well in spring and summer; apply liquid fertilizer every 2 weeks when in growth. Dry off after leaves die down in winter. Propagate by seed or by offsets in spring.

P. geminiflora, syn. *Agave duplicata*, *Bravoa geminiflora*, illus. p.413.

P. tuberosa, syn. *Agave polianthes* (Tuberose), illus. p.385. **‘The Pearl’** is a tuberous perennial. H to 4ft (1.2m), S 6in (15cm). Has a basal cluster of strap-shaped, erect leaves; flower stem also bears leaves on lower part. Produces a spike of funnel-shaped, semidouble or double, white flowers with 6 spreading petals, in summer. Z10–11 (min. 41°F/5°C).

POLIOTHYRSIS

SALICACEAE

Genus of one species of deciduous tree, grown for its foliage and flowers. Fully hardy. Grow in sun or partial shade and in fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate by softwood cuttings in summer.

P. sinensis. Deciduous, spreading tree. H 30ft (10m) or more, S 20ft (6m). Has long, ovate, sharply toothed leaves, glossy and dark green, with wine-red stalks. Fragrant, star-shaped, white, later yellow flowers are borne in late summer and early fall. Z6–9

POLYGALA

Milkwort, Snakeroot

POLYGALACEAE

Genus of annuals and evergreen perennials and shrubs, grown mainly for their pealike flowers. Fully hardy to frost tender. Needs full light or partial shade and moist, but sharply drained soil. Water potted specimens freely when in full growth, moderately at other times. Lanky stems may be cut back hard in late winter. Propagate by seed in spring or by semiripe cuttings in late summer. Susceptible to whitefly.

P. calcarea illus. p.370. **‘Bulley’s Form’** is an evergreen, prostrate perennial. H 1in (2.5cm), S 6in (15cm). Has rosettes of small, narrowly ovate leaves. Bears loose heads of deep blue flowers in late spring and early summer. Prefers humus-rich soil. Z7–9. **‘Lillet’** illus. p.369.

P. chamaebuxus illus. p.371.

var. grandiflora (syn. *P.c. var. purpurea*, *P.c. var. rhodoptera*) illus. p.354. **var. purpurea** see *P.c. var. grandiflora*. **var. rhodoptera** see *P.c. var. grandiflora*. H4 **P. x dalmaisiana**, syn. *P. myrtifolia* var. *grandiflora* of gardens, illus. p.457.

P. myrtifolia var. grandiflora of gardens. See *P. x dalmaisiana*.

P. vayredae. Evergreen, mat-forming shrub. H 2–4in (5–10cm), S 8–12in (20–30cm). Slender, prostrate stems bear small, linear leaves. Pealike, yellow-lipped, reddish-purple flowers are borne in late spring and early summer. Suitable for a rock garden or alpine house. Z7–9

POLYGONATUM

Solomon’s seal

ASPARAGACEAE

Genus of spring- or early summer-flowering, rhizomatous perennials. Fully hardy to half hardy. Requires a cool, shady situation and fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate by division in early spring or by seed in fall. Sawfly caterpillar is a common pest. ☉ All parts may cause mild stomach upset if ingested.

P. biflorum, syn. *P. canaliculatum*, *P. commutatum*, *P. giganteum*. Arching, rhizomatous perennial. H 16–72in (0.4–2m), S 2ft (60cm). Bears ovate to oblong, mid-green leaves. Pendent clusters of bell-shaped, white flowers are borne in leaf axils during late spring. Z3–8

P. canaliculatum. See *P. biflorum*.

P. commutatum. See *P. biflorum*.

P. giganteum. See *P. biflorum*.

P. hirtum, syn. *P. latifolium*. Upright, then arching, rhizomatous perennial. H 4ft (1.2m), S 2ft (60cm). Clusters of 2–5 drooping, tubular, green-tipped, white flowers open in late spring. Undersides of stems, leaf stalks, and ovate to lance-shaped, mid-green leaves are hairy. Z3–8

P. hookeri illus. p.353.

P. x hybridum illus. p.223.

P. latifolium. See *P. hirtum*.

P. multiflorum. Arching, leafy perennial with fleshy rhizomes. H 3ft (90cm), S 10in (25cm). Has ovate to lance-shaped, mid-green leaves. Bears clusters of 2–6 pendent, tubular, green-tipped, white flowers in late spring, then round, black fruits. Z4–8. **‘Flore Pleno’** has double flowers that look like ballet dancers’ skirts.

‘Striatum’ (syn. *P.m. ‘Variegatum’*), H 2ft (60cm), has leaves with creamy-white stripes. **‘Variegatum’** see *P.m. ‘Striatum’*.

P. odoratum. Arching, rhizomatous perennial. H 34in (85cm), S 1ft (30cm). Produces pairs of fragrant, tubular to bell-shaped, green-tipped, white flowers in late spring. Ovate to lance-shaped leaves are mid-green. Z3–8

P. verticillatum (Whorled Solomon’s seal). Upright, rhizomatous perennial. H to 32in (80cm), S 1ft (30cm). Bears whorls of stalkless, lance-shaped, mid-green leaves. In early summer, produces narrowly bell-shaped, greenish-white flowers. Z4–8

Polygonum. See *Persicaria* except for: *P. baldschuanicum* for which see *Fallopia baldschuanica*.

POLYPODIUM

POLYPODIACEAE

Genus of deciduous, semievergreen or mostly evergreen ferns, usually epiphytic and sometimes terrestrial, grown for their sculptural fronds. Fully hardy to frost tender. Grow in partial shade and fibrous, moist but well-drained soil. Propagate by division in spring or by spores in late summer.

P. areolatum. See *Phlebodium pseudoaureum*.

P. aureum. See *Phlebodium aureum*.

P. australe. See *P. cambricum*.

P. cambricum, syn. *P. australe*, *P. vulgare* subsp. *serratum* (Southern polypody).

Deciduous, creeping fern. H 6–24in (15–60cm), S indefinite. Has broadly lance-shaped to broadly triangular-ovate, divided, mid-green fronds, to 2ft (60cm) long, with linear or oblong, often toothed pinnae. New fronds develop in late summer and die back by early summer. Sori are conspicuously yellow in winter. Z3–7. **‘Richard Kayse’** illus. p.293.

P. glycyrrhiza (Liquorice fern). Terrestrial, evergreen fern. H 1ft (30cm) S indefinite. Has oblong-triangular to narrowly ovate, divided, mid-green fronds, with lance-shaped to oblong pinnae that arise from a licorice-scented rootstock. Z5–8. **‘Longicaudatum’** has fronds with very long, pointed tips.

P. interjectum ‘Cornubiense’. See *P. x mantoniae ‘Cornubiense’*.

P. x mantoniae ‘Cornubiense’, syn. *P. interjectum ‘Cornubiense’*, *P. vulgare ‘Cornubiense’*, illus. p.291.